Full Time
Original

INFORMATION SHEET

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COURSE UNIT: COMMUNICATION SKILLS	DATE:
TOPIC: FUNDAMENTAL SKILLS(READING&LISTENING)	TIME:

FUNDAMENTAL SKILLS:

These are basic skills. General speaking skills which are very necessary and important in communication for example, reading, speaking, and note-taking among others.

Sub-skills of Reading:

1.Recognizing of ideas, details etc.

2.Understanding information.

3.Distinguishing the main idea from supporting details. For example.

Late coming is bad; it affects the progress of work

(Main idea) (Supporting details)

4.Skimming (reading for general information)

5.Understanding relations within a sentence.

6. Scanning (reading for specific information)

7.Extracting specific information for summary or note making.

8.Deducing meaning from the text. This substitutes the dictionary meaning/contextual meaning.

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9.Inferring meaning from the text. This substitutes the dictionary meaning, contextual clues.

READING MATERIALS

These are text types that readers can read. They include the following:

- Notes, books, short stories, essays, diaries
- Newspapers and magazines.
- Reports, book review and journals.
- Text books and dictionaries.
- Instructions and recipes
- Minutes of meetings.
- Charts, diagrams and graphs.
- Notices on notice boards
- Advertisements
- Library catalogues.
- Telephone and business directories etc.
- User manuals

TYPES OF READING

1.SKIMMING:

This is reading for general information since the reader needs only an overview, the details of the text are left out. This encourages faster reading because one picks only the main ideas and the structure of the material.

2.SCANNING:

This is a type of reading for specific information. For example ,a telephone number from a telephone directory, a television program from a newspaper.

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Scanning has got its own advantage in that it provides the reader who looks for only key words.

3.INTENSIVE READING

This involves reading for details and it is mainly done for accuracy. Here the reader reads with the aim of understanding a text so as to extract specific accurate information.

4.EXTENSIVE READING

This involves reading longer texts for one's own pleasure. Unlike intensive reading which is accurate based , extensive reading is meant to enhance some ones' knowledge and skills.

ADVANTAGES OF EXTENSIVE READING

- It enables the reader to consolidate the reading skills already gained.
- The reader gains knowledge of the world, about other people and their cultures.
- It inculcates the reading culture in society.
- It stimulates the reader's imagination with new ideas and experiences.

PURPOSES OF READING

There are 3 main reasons why we read. These are :

1.Reading for pleasure.

Many people read for enjoyment or to pass time.

2.Reading for information:

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most people read in order to get facts a bouts different aspects of life. For example, materials for course work, new items, new job requirements etc.

3.Reading for judgment:

Most people read in order to compare notes or opinions and thus be able to put forward their own opinions or judgments.

READING SPEED AND COMPREHENSION

Speed reading and comprehension requires speed and accuracy. This can be achieved by using the five stages of reading commonly known as SQ3R

S-Survey

Q-Question

3R-Read

-Recall

-Review

These are also called the five stages of reading:

1.SURVEY

This is the first stage of reading. When surveying a text, scanning and skimming can be used depending on the length of the reading text. For example, if you want to read only a particular section of a document, you need to scan the table of contents and possibly the index in order to pay particular reference to what you are interested in. On the other hand, if it is a big document then you have to skim through. In this case reading preface and synopsis can also be very valuable.

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2.QUESTION

This is the second stage of reading ; ask critical questions that can aid you in understanding the text. For example, what is it a bout? Etc. Many of these questions should occur during the survey and the actual reading.

3.READ

This is the third stage of reading. At this stage it is better to read fairly fast so as to have a second reading. If it is a personal text then it's rewarding to underline or highlight the main ideas but avoid taking down notes. Note- taking can distract your attention apart from slowing down your reading speed.

4.RECALL

This is the fourth stage of reading. Try to recall the main ideas and supporting details. At this stage you can take notes if necessary. For example, for the purpose of revision.

5.REVIEW

This is the fifth stage and the last stage of reading. It is at this stage that one cross-check an essential idea that has been left out or missed out at the other stages. The review stage consists of going back very repeatedly to the previous stages.

THE IMPORTANCE OF READING

1.It stimulates the readers imagination

By reading, you are exposed to so many wonderful things. This helps your imagination when it comes to creating and thinking. By reading, you are painting those pictures of the story in your mind. Books can take you anywhere you want to go.

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2.Focus and concentration is built in the reader.

Reading makes you to focus and concentrate on one thing.

By sitting still and reading, you are training your body/mind to slow down, relax, and focus on what you are reading. This helps you to be focused and concentrate on other activities because you are used to doing it.

3.Reading improves your memory.

When you read a book or any text, you are taking in all what it is about. People, places, things among others.

4.Language development

Through reading different pieces of texts by different authors, one will acquire new words and this will help increase a ones vocabulary. This will enable one develop a language.

LISTENING SKILLS

Listening is giving ones attention to the person or sound. Listening is a receptive skills, it takes energy and attention. The listener usually makes sense out of the information passed on by the speaker. To this effect, both listening and speaking go hand in hand. Without the speaker we cannot have the listener and in the same way without the listener we cannot have the speaker.

Alternatively, listening can also be defined as the process of receiving sound using the hearing sense, and making sense of it.

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WHAT WE LISTEN TO AND FOR

Listening to- refers to the listening material. For example, News, Speeches, Sermons, Announcements, lectures etc. Whereas listening for refers to the purpose of listening. That is to say, we listen to News from radios &Televisions; we listen for information on current affairs.

What we listen to	Listening for
1.News. (Radios, TVS) 2.Speeches 3.Poems 4.Sermons in church 5.Lectures 6.Songs 7.Announcements 8.Stories 9.Advertisements .	✓ For information on current Affairs ✓ For information ✓ Tone, subject matter, mood, rhymes etc. ✓ For moral message. ✓ Encouraging information. ✓ For knowledge ✓ For entertainment & meaning. ✓ For information ✓ Obituary message

What do we listen to in a classroom environment?

- ❖ The subject or content of the given lesson.
- ❖ Tenses used during the lesson.
- ❖ Vocabulary.
- ❖ Sound that pose a problem.

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TYPES OF LISTENING:

1.PASSIVE LISTENING.

This is listening where the listener hears something but does not pay response to it. No response is expected from him or her. For example, during the lesson where students are divided into groups for discussion. Members of one group are not supposed to pay attention to what members of another group are saying more especially when given different topic for discussion.

2.LISTENING FOR GIST/GLOBAL LISTENING

This is when the listener listens for general information. He does not pay close attention to anything specific, but he listens to general information. Fore example listening to news during the general assemblies.

3. SELECTIVE LISTENING OR LISTENING FOR SPECIFIC INFORMATION

This is where the listener listens to some parts of the texts and specifically to those parts of the text that fulfill his/her needs of listening e.g when students are listening to text being read to them aloud. Whereas they listen they are looking for answers to the questions being given to them earlier. In this kind of listening, the listener is on close attention and she is on lookout for those parts that carry answers to those parts of the questions given.

4. INTENSIVE LISTENING

This is a type of listening which requires the listener to listen for details. The listener pays close attention to all the parts of the text so as to get the details about that text.

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BARRIERS TO EFFECTIVE LISTENING

Effective communication is a very essential skill in life. It is very important in the family, at school and in the work place. Listening properly is the most important part of effective communication. Poor listening skills will negatively affect the nature of feedback given by the receiver to the sender.

The barriers to effective listening refers to the many things that get in the way of listening. These include:

1.Excessive Talking

Talking more than necessary is a barrier to effective communication and results into poor listening. People normally refuse to talk to someone who talks excessively without listening to them.

2.Prejudice

This is a preconceived negative opinion about someone speaking. The reason for prejudice against the speaker is usually biased. It may be due to his or her age,tribe,race,religion or appearance.

3.Noise

Noise is unwanted sound and it is a great obstacle to clear communication. A noisy environment is very bad both to the speaker and the listener because it is impossible to listen in such an environment.

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4.Divided attention.

This is where some ones focus and attention is torn between two things. For example the person may be thinking of what to have for lunch , supper or what to wear for the party that day.

5.Interruption

Interrupting a conversation with improper body language or inappropriate words will have a negative impact in effective communication.

6.Fear.

Fear is a great barrier to listening. People who are afraid during a conversation are not likely to listen. They become defensive and tend to argue.

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